

Participant Information Sheet for LinTeX User Study

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Name of department: Computer and Information Sciences

Title of the study: LinTeX: Promoting Accessibility in LaTeX Documents

Introduction

I am Mohammad Danyal, a final year Undergraduate Computer Science student at the University of Strathclyde. I can be contacted by email via mohammad.danyal.2023@uni.strath.ac.uk should any concerns or questions arise regarding the study, or if you wish to withdraw your participation.

What is the purpose of this research?

Modern LaTeX documents tend to use PDFLaTeX as opposed to LuaLaTeX. Thus, they often require workarounds to implement features and lack accessibility support.

LinTeX is a prototype to combat accessibility with emphasis placed on screen readers, and avoiding counter-productive workarounds.

This user study will identify the effectiveness of a new tool, LinTeX, to promote accessibility in LaTeX documents, as well as its usability to a wider audience.

Do you have to take part?

Participation in the research is entirely voluntary.

Refusing to participate in or withdrawing from the study will not affect the ways an individual is treated.

Participants may withdraw from the study at any stage without providing a reason.

If you wish to withdraw from the study at any stage, please contact mohammad.danyal.2023@uni.strath.ac.uk.

What will you do in the project?

Participants will be asked to meet in-person in the University of Strathclyde's campus at a pre-arranged time and date.

Participants will be provided with a LaTeX document at the start of the user study. Participants will then listen to a screen reader's output for the LaTeX document.

Afterwards, participants will be asked questions about their thoughts on the output.

Participants will then be requested to use LinTeX in a think-aloud session, where you say what you are thinking, to improve the document's accessibility through improvements suggested by LinTeX.

Participants will finally repeat the initial step of listening to a screen reader's output for the improved document and answer questions regarding their opinion of what went well and what could have been improved.

Why have you been invited to take part?

Participants of the research study may benefit from the LinTeX tool and have been asked to assist in its development through an in-person think-aloud user study.

Participants must be a member of the University of Strathclyde, or another higher education facility. Travel costs cannot be reimbursed.

Participants should be 18-years old or above.

Participants will require prior experience with LaTeX to participate in the study and have been selected based on these criteria.

What information is being collected in the project?

Personal information that may be stored include the participants' names and email addresses. This datum is stored to ensure communication is thorough in arranging a time and date to participate in the study. Additionally, some information stored about the participants' usage of the system or answers to questions may be personal.

Non-identifiable information that may be stored include anonymised information extracted from the user study.

No audio or video recording will be created. No transcripts will be created.

Who will have access to the information?

Only the researcher will have access to any Personally Identifiable Information (PIP). Anonymised information may be included in the research paper and shared with the supervisor.

Where will the information be stored and how long will it be kept for?

All data will be stored only in password-protected folders on OneDrive, with Personally Identifiable Information (PIP) and anonymous data stored in separate folders.

All data stored in these folders will be deleted on 1st August 2026. However, any data that is anonymised and included in the study may not be possible to remove.

Physical notes may be taken during the user study, which will be digitalised within a week. Once digitalised, it will be securely destroyed.

Thank you for reading this information – please ask any questions if you are unsure about what is written here.

All personal data will be processed in accordance with applicable Scottish data protection legislation. Please read our [Privacy Notice for Research Participants](#) for more information about your rights under the legislation.

What happens next?

If you are interested in the project, or continuing with the user study, please contact me by email via mohammad.danyal.2023@uni.strath.ac.uk. Participants will be requested to sign a consent form prior to participation in the user study.

All information collected in the user study will be anonymised before being published.

If participants are interested in participating in any future related studies, the aforementioned email address can be used to register your interest.

If you are no longer interested in participating in the project, no further steps will be required. Thank you for your time.

Researcher contact details:

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Chief Investigator details:

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This research was granted ethical approval by the Department of Computer and Information Sciences Ethics Committee.

If you have any questions/concerns, during or after the research, or wish to contact an independent person to whom any questions may be directed or further information may be sought from, please contact: cis-ethics@strath.ac.uk